



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

UNIVERSITY FACULTY VS. USC

USC graduate student Glenn Harter holds a sign at Wednesday’s rally for the faculty’s union. The university has asked the National Labor Relations Board to reject the unionization vote. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Film, TV industry hopeful with aid from U.S.

President’s support of federal tax credit lifts Hollywood’s optimism about possible lifeline.

BY SAMANTHA MASUNAGA

For years, Hollywood has talked about a federal film and television tax credit that could help the industry combat the growing number of productions fleeing overseas.

This week, the entertainment business got a glimmer of hope.

After more than a year of quiet work from California lawmakers, industry lobbyists and Hollywood unions to build a bipartisan coalition, President Trump endorsed the effort in a post on his social media website, providing a major boost for the issue.

If passed, a federal incentive is expected to help draw some productions back to the Golden State, industry experts and advocates said. Although it probably won’t immediately end Southern California’s production crisis — as many states now have established film hubs stocked with experienced crews and more generous tax breaks — an added federal credit certainly could help make California more competitive, they said.

“I will put our crews and our talent against any talent anywhere in the world,” said U.S. Rep. Laura Friedman (D-Glendale), a former producer who has been pushing for a national film tax credit. “If we have a level playing field upon which to shoot, where we are not much more expensive than other locations, productions will come back to Los Angeles.”

Trump’s post came after a meeting with actor Jon Voight, one of the president’s designated Hollywood ambassadors who has played a key role in lobbying [See Credit, A12]

GLORIA STEINEM, 1934 - 2026

Charismatic feminist, Ms. magazine co-founder

BY STEVE CHAWKINS AND SONJA SHARP

Eating breakfast in a South Dakota coffee shop, Gloria Steinem was all too aware of the couple eyeballing her from the next booth. He was sporting chains. She wore leather pants and what Steinem later recalled as “an improbable hairdo.” The place was packed with tough-looking, mostly male bikers pumped about a huge rally they were attending. Steinem, returning from a Sioux powwow honoring ancient tribal women, knew she wasn’t in her element.

Finally, the leather-clad woman came

over and spoke up. “I just want to tell you how much Ms. magazine has meant to me over the years — and my husband too,” she told an astonished Steinem.

There was a time, the woman said, when rolling down the road meant perching on her husband’s back seat. But now she had her own sweet ride: “I even put ‘Ms.’ on my license plate, and you should see my grandkids’ faces when Grandma rides up on her purple Harley!”

The image of that breezy, boisterous grandma stayed with Steinem for years. “I’ve come to believe that inside, each of us has a purple motorcycle,” she wrote in her 2015 memoir. “We have only to discover it — and ride.”

[See Steinem, A7]



BETTYE LANE Getty Images

LIGHTING OTHERS’ TORCHES

Despite her singular fame, Gloria Steinem — shown at a rally in 1978 — rarely took the stage alone, amplifying the work of contemporaries.

County abuse payouts paused

Concerns with settlement affect thousands of claims

BY REBECCA ELLIS

Two law firms behind the bulk of claims in L.A. County’s \$4-billion sex abuse settlement have had their payouts delayed pending probes, leaving many clients who expected life-changing sums stuck in limbo.

The first checks from the

settlement — the largest of its kind in U.S. history — were supposed to start going out this summer after a judge rejected Dist. Atty. Nathan Hochman’s request to freeze the funds over fraud concerns. Many claims are thought to be legitimate and no plaintiffs in the settlement have been charged with wrongdoing.

But Slater Slater Schulman, which represents roughly 3,700 people in the case, emailed clients two weeks ago that the firm has “temporarily paused” payments due to an unanticipated audit of their cases.

Clifford Robert, outside counsel representing Slater, told The Times that the firm [See Settlement, A8]

Plan to kill Catalina deer can move forward

BY ALEX WIGGLESWORTH

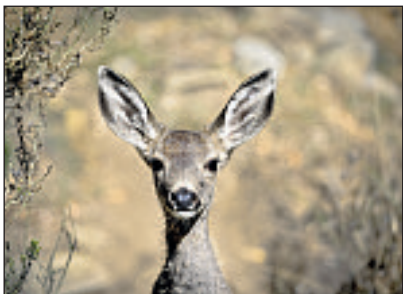
The killing of mule deer on Catalina Island will go forward after a judge denied a request from hunting groups and concerned citizens to pause the controversial plan pending the outcome of a legal challenge.

The Catalina Island Conservancy was authorized to start killing deer Tuesday under a permit issued by the California Department of Fish and Wildlife and said it would proceed while awaiting a final ruling. The conser-

vancy, which manages 88% of the island, announced last year that it would use contracted hunters to shoot the invasive deer over four to five years as part of an ecosystem restoration plan.

Roughly 200 deer will be killed from September through October as part of an initial phase to test methods and see whether any other tools or equipment are needed when crews expand the process next year, said Pepe Barton, director of communications for the Catalina Island Conservancy.

About 22 deer were brought to the [See Deer, A8]



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

ABOUT 200 mule deer will be killed this fall in a test phase.

Trump targets private schools’ tax-exempt status

Proposed rule, to take effect in 2027, escalates a push to end help for minority students.

BY HOWARD BLUME, JAWEED KALEEM AND COLLIN BINKLEY

The Trump administration is proposing a new rule that would strip private colleges and private grade schools of their tax-exempt status if they provide targeted help to students based on their race, a significant escalation in the White House’s campaign to eradicate diversity programs directed at Black, Latino and other minority students.

Critics call the move blatantly illegal and short-sighted, saying it does “nothing to make education fairer.”

The Treasury Department proposed the change Thursday in a new regulation that, if made final, would take effect after May 2027. The rule is broadly aimed at ending any policies or programs that help students because of their race, and it specifically says such benefits in admissions, scholarships and facilities

“would be incompatible” with the rule.

It’s the latest attempt by the Trump administration to pressure schools and colleges to end diversity, equity and inclusion policies that President Trump vowed to eliminate. Trump officials have used civil rights laws to unwind the policies, saying they discriminate against white and Asian American students.

“Private educational institutions that promote discriminatory practices will no longer be afforded the benefits of federal tax-exempt status,” said IRS Chief Executive Frank Bisignano. “Today’s proposed regulations put institutions on notice and schools that continue to engage in racial discrimination should expect to lose that status.”

The proposed change would not only impose a tax bill on schools, but also could discourage donors who would lose the advantage of deducting the donation to lower their taxes. A public comment period is expected to last until early November.

In California, the proposed changes would cover more than 85 nonprofit colleges and universities, [See Trump, A6]

LAUSD blocks AI access for students

Generative models are banned through year’s end amid push to curb computer use.

BY HOWARD BLUME

The Los Angeles public school district has enacted a moratorium on student use of generative artificial intelligence for the current school year, officials said this week, a major step with national significance that limits computer use in classrooms amid rising parent concerns about the reliance on technology in schools.

The moratorium came to light at the first meeting of a school board committee examining issues around the use of AI in schools — a surprise to board members who were told by their chief academic officer and their head of technology that the new policy means generative AI would be out of reach for all students on district devices until further notice.

Senior district administrators put the moratorium in place on their own author-

ity in the spirit of complying with the school board’s unanimous June vote to limit student screen time. Under the screen-time policy, students have no access to screens until the second grade and permissible screen time is gradually expanded as students get older.

Board member Kelly Gonez said that, to her knowledge, the district was still following an earlier policy that made AI available to older students after they had completed instructional units on digital literacy and responsibility.

“I, even as a board member,” was “under the expectation that we were still operating under last year’s policy,” Gonez said. “The fact that it’s different today, this school year, is important.”

“Breaking news here in the committee,” Gonez said later, smiling.

Board member Nick Melvoin also expressed surprise, although like Gonez, he did not object to the de facto moratorium. He said it was important for the word to get out, while noting that [See LAUSD, A6]



DAVE CHAN AFP/Getty Images

UNCHARTED WATERS

Apple and Google relabel Lake Ontario in their map apps at President Trump’s behest, a move that risks upsetting customers. **BUSINESS, A10**

Adding bachelor degree options

Two bills would allow community colleges to expand offerings to fill needs of the workforce. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather

Partly sunny. L.A. Basin: 82/63. **B6**

Markets **A12**
Opinion Voices **A13**

Surprise awaits at Telluride

Colorado film festival promises a secret and starry world premiere. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

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